A Numerical Algorithm for simulating multiphase flows: ice, melt, vapor, deformable solids, high speed, and low speed flows *

Estebe, Cody
Dept. of math, FL State Univ.

Liu, Yang
Dept. of Mech. Engr., FL State Univ.

Sussman, Mark
Dept. of math, FL State Univ.

Moradikazerouni, Alireza
Dept. of Mech. Engr., FL State Univ.

Shoele, Kourosh
Dept. of Mech. Engr., FL State Univ.

Ohta, Mitsuhiro
Dept. of Mech. Sci, Tokushima University

April 2, 2026

ABSTRACT: A new Eulerian method is presented for simulating complex multiphase flows consisting of any number of types of materials, to include compressible fluids, incompressible fluids, ice, melt, vapor, and solids undergoing plastic deformation. The interfaces between materials is modeled and discretized as sharp.

1 Mathematical Modeling

There are M materials and each material $1 \leq m \leq M$ occupies the region,

$$\Omega_m(t) = \{(\vec{x}, t) | \phi_m(\vec{x}, t) \geq 0\} \tag{1}$$

*this material is based upon work supported by National Aeronautics and Space Administration under grant number 80NSSC20K0352

The $\phi_m(\boldsymbol{x}, t)$ are level set functions[**?**]. The zero level set of such functions demarcate the boundary of material m:

$$\partial\Omega_m(t) = \{(\vec{x}, t))|\phi_m(\vec{x}, t) = 0\} \tag{2}$$

In the bulk regions of material m we have the following equations for compressible materials:

$$\rho_t + \nabla \cdot (\rho\vec{u}) = 0 \tag{3}$$

$$(\rho\vec{u})_t + \nabla \cdot (\rho\vec{u} \otimes \vec{u} + p\mathbb{I} - \tau) = \vec{F}_{body} \tag{4}$$

$$(\rho E)_t + \nabla \cdot ((\rho E + p)\vec{u} - \vec{u} \cdot \tau - k\nabla T) = \vec{u} \cdot \vec{F}_{body} \tag{5}$$

$$(\rho Y)_t + \nabla \cdot (\rho Y\vec{u}) = \nabla \cdot (\rho D \nabla Y) \tag{6}$$

$$\tau = 2\mu\bar{D} \tag{7}$$

$$\bar{D} = D - \frac{\mathrm{Trace}(D)\mathbb{I}}{\mathrm{Trace}(\mathbb{I})} \tag{8}$$

$$D = \frac{\nabla\vec{u} + (\nabla\vec{u})^T}{2} \tag{9}$$

$$\rho E = \rho e_{\mathrm{int}} + \frac{1}{2}\rho|\vec{u}|^2 \tag{10}$$

$$p = p(\rho, e) \quad e = c_v T \tag{11}$$

If the material is a viscoelastic FENE-CR material, then one has the additional equation for the configuration tensor A,

$$A_t + \vec{u} \cdot \nabla A = A \cdot (\nabla\vec{u})^T + \nabla\vec{u} \cdot A - \frac{f(R)}{\lambda}(A - \mathbb{I}), \tag{12}$$

and the momentum constitutive law term is modified,

$$\tau = \tau + \frac{\tilde{\eta}_P}{\lambda} f(R) A. \tag{13}$$

If the material is an elastic material undergoing plastic deformation, then one has the following additional equation for the deviatoric stress tensor,

$$s_t + \vec{u} \cdot \nabla s + s\Omega - \Omega s = 2G(\bar{D} - D^p), \tag{14}$$

and the momentum constitutive law term is modified,

$$\tau = \tau + s. \tag{15}$$

If the material is an elastic material undergoing plastic deformation, then the plastic strain equation is solved too,

$$\epsilon_t^p + \vec{u} \cdot \nabla \epsilon^p = \sqrt{\frac{2}{3}} |\Lambda|. \tag{16}$$

$$|\Lambda| = \sqrt{\frac{3}{2}} \sqrt{D^p : D^p} \tag{17}$$

$$D^p = \Lambda N \quad N = \sqrt{3/2} \frac{s}{S_e} \quad (\dot{\epsilon}^p)^2 = \frac{2}{3} \Lambda^2 \tag{18}$$

Ω is the spin tensor,

$$\Omega_{ij} = \frac{1}{2} (\frac{\partial u_i}{\partial x_j} - \frac{\partial u_j}{\partial x_i}) \tag{19}$$

The effective stress is defined as,

$$S_e = \sqrt{\frac{3}{2}} \sqrt{s : s} \tag{20}$$

The Johnson-Cook model yield stress is given by,

$$\sigma_y = (A + B(\epsilon^p)^n)(1 + C \ln(\frac{\dot{\epsilon}^p}{\dot{\epsilon}_0}))(1 - \theta^m) \quad \theta = \frac{T - T_0}{T_m - T_0} \tag{21}$$

One form of the Zerilli Armstrong model yield stress is given by,

$$\beta = \beta_0 - \beta_1 \log(\dot{\epsilon}^p / \dot{\epsilon}^p_{ref}) \tag{22}$$

$$\sigma_y = A + B(\epsilon^p)^n e^{-\beta T} \tag{23}$$

The energy contribution due to elasto-plastic deformation is modeled as,

$$\beta \dot{\epsilon}^p S_e, \tag{24}$$

and is added to (5). In order to determine Λ, as it appears in (18), the following "radial return algorithm" is implemented (see [1] for the case when $n = 1$ in (21) or (23)):

1. $\dot{\epsilon}^p = 0$, $k = 0$

2. $S_e = \sqrt{\frac{3}{2}} \sqrt{s : s}$

3. $\sigma_y = \sigma_y(T, \epsilon^p, \dot{\epsilon}^p)$

4. if $S_e - \sigma_y \leq 0$ then $\Lambda = 0$ (i.e. $D^p : D^p = 0$).

5. if $S_e > \sigma_y$ then,

6. Solve the following equation for ϵ^p_{new}:

$$S_e - \sigma_y = 3G(\epsilon^p_{new} - \epsilon^p) + B((\epsilon^p_{new})^n - (\epsilon^p)^n) \tag{25}$$

7.

$$\dot{\epsilon}^p = \frac{\epsilon^p_{new} - \epsilon^p}{\Delta t} \tag{26}$$

8.

$$\Lambda = \sqrt{\frac{3}{2}}\dot{\epsilon}^p \tag{27}$$

$$D^p = \Lambda N \tag{28}$$

9. $k = k + 1$

10. if $k = 1$ then go back to step 3.

The mathematical model at sharp interfaces is given as follows. First, define a "closest point" function:

$$\vec{x}_c(\vec{x}) = \text{argmin}_{\vec{y},m} \{||\vec{y} - \vec{x}|| | \phi_m(\vec{y}) = 0\} \tag{29}$$

Taking into account mass transfer, a source material's level set function (e.g. ice that is melting or liquid that is turning into vapor) satisfies

$$(\phi_{m_s})_t + \vec{u}_{m_s}(\vec{x}_c(\vec{x})) \cdot \nabla\phi_{m_s} = -\frac{|\dot{m}(\vec{x}_c(\vec{x}))|}{\rho_{m_s}}|\nabla\phi_{m_s}| \tag{30}$$

The destination material's level set function satisfies

$$(\phi_{m_d})_t + \vec{u}_{m_s}(\vec{x}_c(\vec{x})) \cdot \nabla\phi_{m_d} = \frac{|\dot{m}(\vec{x}_c(\vec{x}))|}{\rho_{m_s}}|\nabla\phi_{m_d}| \tag{31}$$

The above equations are equivalent to the following:

$$(\phi_{m_s})_t + \vec{u}_{m_d}(\vec{x}_c(\vec{x})) \cdot \nabla\phi_{m_s} = -\frac{|\dot{m}(\vec{x}_c(\vec{x}))|}{\rho_{m_d}}|\nabla\phi_{m_s}| \tag{32}$$

$$(\phi_{m_d})_t + \vec{u}_{m_d}(\vec{x}_c(\vec{x})) \cdot \nabla\phi_{m_d} = \frac{|\dot{m}(\vec{x}_c(\vec{x}))|}{\rho_{m_d}}|\nabla\phi_{m_d}| \tag{33}$$

Now, we define the interface normal:

$$\vec{n}_m = \frac{\nabla \phi_m}{||\nabla \phi_m||} \tag{34}$$

The interface curvature is,

$$\kappa_m = \nabla \cdot \vec{n}_m \tag{35}$$

The rate of mass transfer is,

$$\dot{m} = \frac{k_{m_s} \nabla T_{m_s} - k_{m_d} \nabla T_{m_d}}{L} \cdot \vec{n}_{m_d}. \tag{36}$$

For evaporation, the following rate of mass transfer should match that in (36):

$$\dot{m} = \frac{-\vec{n}_{m_s} \cdot \nabla Y_{m_d} \rho_{m_d} D}{Y^{\Gamma} - 1} \tag{37}$$

Let the tensor σ represent pressure, viscosity, viscoelastic, and elastic contributions to the momentum equations. One has:

$$\sigma = -p\mathbb{I} + \tau. \tag{38}$$

The stress jump conditions are

$$\vec{n}_{m_s} \cdot (-\sigma_{m_s} + \sigma_{m_d}) \cdot \vec{n}_{m_s} = -\gamma_{m_s,m_d} \kappa_{m_s} - \dot{m}^2 (\frac{1}{\rho_{m_s}} - \frac{1}{\rho_{m_d}}) \tag{39}$$

$$(\vec{t}_{i,tangent})_{m_s} \cdot (-\sigma_{m_s} + \sigma_{m_d}) \cdot \vec{n}_{m_s} = 0 \quad i = 1, 2 \tag{40}$$

The velocity jump conditions are

$$(\vec{u}_{m_s} - \vec{u}_{m_d}) \cdot \vec{n}_{m_s} = \dot{m} (\frac{1}{\rho_{m_d}} - \frac{1}{\rho_{m_s}}) \tag{41}$$

References

[1] Tran, L., and Udaykumar, H. A particle-level set-based sharp interface cartesian grid method for impact, penetration, and void collapse. *Journal of Computational Physics 193*, 2 (2004), 469–510.